



Regulations for Umrah Services and Visitors of the Prophet's Mosque Arriving from Outside the Kingdom on Umrah Visas

Season: 1448 AH

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Introduction

Out of the Ministry's keenness to elevate the level of services provided to the Guests of Allah, in partnership with the private sector, and in accordance with the Regulations of Services for Umrah Pilgrims and Visitors of the Prophet's Mosque Arriving from Outside the Kingdom—issued by Council of Ministers Resolution No. (93) dated 10/6/1420 AH and its amendments by Council of Ministers Resolution No. (439) dated 20/11/1435 AH and its Executive Regulations—and pursuant to the royal decrees and orders issued to support the Hajj and Umrah sector, this Regulatory Document has been prepared for all such services, taking into account all instructions approved by the relevant authorities within the Umrah ecosystem, as follows:

First: General Obligations of Saudi Umrah Companies and Establishments:

A. Toward the Ministry:

1. Compliance with the Regulations of Services for Umrah Pilgrims and Visitors of the Prophet's Mosque Arriving from Outside the Kingdom issued by Council of Ministers Resolution No. (93) dated 10/6/1420 AH and its amendments by Resolution No. (439) dated 20/11/1435 AH and its Executive Regulations, as well as royal decrees and orders issued to support the Hajj and Umrah sector, and the regulations and instructions issued by this Ministry and relevant authorities.
2. Contracting with service providers licensed by the competent authorities (accommodation, transportation, catering, etc.) via the Nusuk Masar Platform (masar.nusuk.sa).
3. Participation of Umrah company and establishment personnel in training programs conducted by the Ministry.
4. Training and qualifying employees in accordance with the security and safety requirements mandated by the competent authorities.
5. Providing the necessary administrative and field staff for the service and registering them on the Nusuk Masar platform, including contact details and duty officers; the company or establishment shall bear responsibility for any inaccurate data.
6. Contributing to the achievement of the targets approved by the Ministry regarding the number of pilgrims, the quality of services provided, and performance efficiency.
7. All representatives of Umrah companies and establishments are committed to carrying functional identification cards issued by their employer.
8. Updating the National Address data for the company's headquarters, all its branches, employees, and contact methods.
9. Interacting with reports and notices communicated to companies via the Ministry's approved communication channels and addressing them within the approved timeframes.

B. Toward the Pilgrim:

1. Serving the pilgrim with all honesty and sincerity.
2. Ensuring the pilgrim's program includes the basic services required for issuing an Umrah visa (accommodation, transportation within the Kingdom between ports and residences, insurance, and ground services), provided that the program duration matches the pilgrim's actual stay within the

Kingdom without exceeding the residency validity, and implementing it as agreed upon with the pilgrim, with emphasis on adhering to the arrival and departure dates—to and from the Kingdom—fixed within the program.

3. Entering accurate data into the Umrah Automated System regarding the pilgrim's program and their actual movements throughout the trip, and updating such data promptly should any variables arise, whether before the pilgrims' arrival or during their stay within the Kingdom. All entries and updates must be completed according to the timeframes specified in this document and the approved user manual for the Umrah Automated System.
4. Educating pilgrims on the importance of creating an account on the Nusuk App to obtain the necessary permits (performing Umrah and praying in the Noble Rawdah), in alignment with the pilgrim's program.
5. Monitoring the delivery of the contracted service packages within the pilgrim's bundle and working to rectify any deficiencies or service breaches immediately.
6. Providing necessary services to the pilgrim during their stay in the Kingdom in the event of any incidents or accidents and the resulting regulatory, security, health, or death cases, and finalizing all necessary procedures according to the case in coordination with this Ministry and the competent authorities.
7. Constant communication with the pilgrim during their stay in the Kingdom, verifying that they receive their designated services, and assisting them with any inquiries, additional services, or challenges they may face during the trip.
8. A company representative must accompany pilgrims during their enrichment programs, such as visits to historical sites, and contract with licensed guides to provide tourist guidance services.
9. Verifying the availability of confirmed bookings and travel tickets for the pilgrim's arrival to and departure from the Kingdom, and addressing any challenges that may arise regarding them.
10. Educating the pilgrim on the importance of adhering to the program duration and departing at the specified time on the return date, while ensuring the Umrah company takes legal action upon the expiration of the Umrah visa.

C. Toward External Travel Agencies and Umrah Company Partners:

1. Promptly informing all their agents outside the Kingdom of all regulations and instructions issued by this Ministry and relevant authorities, verifying agents' compliance with implementation and their communication of these rules to pilgrims, including:
 - Adherence to health requirements issued by the Ministry of Health in the Kingdom.
 - Following regulations and guidelines regarding not carrying any prohibited materials upon arrival for Umrah and visitation, and ensuring no restricted items are introduced to avoid legal penalties.
 - Compliance with customs disclosure instructions at ports of entry or departure in accordance with the organizing regulations.
2. Informing agents outside the Kingdom and pilgrims wishing to arrive via land ports of the regulations for foreign buses and cars arriving from outside the Kingdom as follows:
 - Prohibition of practicing internal transport (transporting passengers within or between cities for a fee) in any form.

- The driver and passengers must possess a passport containing a valid entry visa to the Kingdom for Umrah.
- Vehicles must be registered at the entry port, with proof of ownership from an authorized official body, and linked to the entry number of the driver or owner to record violations via automated monitoring, if applicable.
- The vehicle must have comprehensive insurance equivalent to the visa duration, set at (3) months.
- The vehicle's registration and periodic technical inspection must be valid.
- The driver must hold an internationally recognized vehicle license compatible with the size and power of the vehicle.
- Owners or drivers of these vehicles pledge to comply with the systems, laws, and instructions governing the Hajj and Umrah season, such as parking vehicles in official authorized parking areas at the entrances of the Holy Capital (Makkah) and Madinah, and using authorized means of transportation during the Hajj and Umrah season.
- Adherence to the vehicle's load capacity according to the systems and instructions in force in the Kingdom.
- Commitment not to place any religious or partisan logos or stickers on the vehicle.

Second: General Obligations of External Agents:

A. Toward the Pilgrim:

1. Communicating with the pilgrim and clarifying the details of the contracted program, the services they will receive during their stay in the Kingdom, and the contact details of the responsible Saudi Umrah company.
2. Continuous coordination with the contracted Saudi Umrah company to ensure serving the pilgrim with all honesty and sincerity.
3. Informing pilgrims of all regulations and instructions issued by this Ministry and relevant authorities, as well as all requirements regarding arrival and residency in the Kingdom.
4. Commitment to the pilgrims' arrival in the Kingdom at the time specified in the program under which the Umrah visa was granted, and informing the Umrah company of any changes to the program before arrival.
5. Providing confirmed round-trip travel tickets for pilgrims.
6. Providing the pilgrim with an educational brochure in their language prior to arrival, covering: (performing Umrah and visitation rituals, residency regulations in Saudi Arabia, and Umrah and visitation systems); this is to be prepared in coordination with the contracted Saudi Umrah company.
7. Emphasizing to pilgrims the necessity of wearing identification cards upon arrival via all sea, air, and land ports to enable relevant authorities to identify them and provide services. These cards must include the Ministry's Care Center contact number (1966 from within the Kingdom, +966 920002814 from abroad) and its channels for receiving complaints and reports via email (care@haj.gov.sa), X platform account (@MOHU_Care), and Facebook account (MOHU_Care).

8. Educating the pilgrim on the importance of adhering to the program duration and departing at the specified time on the return date, while coordinating with Umrah companies to take regulatory measures upon the expiration of the Umrah visa.

B. Toward the Ministry:

1. Commitment to implementing all regulations and instructions issued by this Ministry and the relevant authorities.
2. Commitment to transferring all financial amounts related to service packages from the agent's account outside the Kingdom to their financial wallet on the Umrah Electronic Track.

C. Toward Saudi Umrah Companies and Establishments:

1. Refraining from the direct purchase or provision of services within the Kingdom except through the contracted Saudi Umrah company.
2. Sharing the pilgrim's contact data with the Saudi Umrah company after verifying its accuracy.

Third: Operational Constraints and Timeframes for the Umrah Season:

1. Commencement of Umrah visa issuance: Starting from the 14th of Dhu al-Hijjah of each year.
2. Deadline for Umrah visa issuance: The 1st of Shawwal of each year.
3. Commencement of pilgrims' entry: Starting from the 14th of Dhu al-Hijjah of each year, taking into account that contracted programs in Makkah shall begin from the 15th of Dhu al-Hijjah of each year.
4. Deadline for pilgrims' entry into the Kingdom: The 15th of Shawwal of each year.
5. Expiration of stay and departure: All pilgrims must depart the Kingdom by the end of the month of Shawwal each year. The Ministry and competent authorities will apply regulations against violators.

Fourth: Umrah Visa Fees and Service Charges Policies:

Umrah visa fees and associated electronic and insurance services are non-refundable once the request is submitted by the Umrah company on the Nusuk Masar platform. As for other services included in the pilgrim's program (accommodation, transportation, enrichment services, etc.), the policies agreed upon between the Umrah company and the (Pilgrim/External Agent) shall apply.

Fifth: Qualification Standards for External Agents Operating in the Umrah Season:

External agents wishing to provide services to pilgrims must apply for qualification and complete the application via the Nusuk Masar platform (<https://masar.nusuk.sa>), adhering to the regulations outlined on the platform and attaching the following documents:

- A copy of the external agent's commercial registration, certified by an official authorized body in the agent's country.
- A copy of the valid passport of the facility's authorized manager.
- In the case of having operated in previous Umrah seasons, a financial clearance from the last Saudi Umrah company or establishment contracted must be provided.
- The external agency's financial data, certified by the bank.

Note: The Ministry of Hajj and Umrah reserves the right to suspend or cancel the application at its discretion.

Sixth: Contracting Regulations between Saudi Umrah Companies and External Agents:

1. Commitment to contracting between both parties using the Unified Electronic Contract form approved on the Nusuk Masar platform.
2. Acknowledgment by the Saudi Umrah company of the receipt of the bank guarantee provided by the external agent in the amount of two hundred thousand (SAR 200,000).
3. Commitment to the regulations and instructions issued by the competent authorities in the Kingdom regarding all commercial and financial transactions.

Seventh: Regulations for Services Provided through Umrah Companies:

A. Accommodation Services:

No.	Regulations
1	Contracting with accommodations and hotels licensed by the Ministry of Tourism via the Nusuk Masar platform.
2	Verifying the readiness of accommodations prior to the arrival of pilgrims.
3	Receiving pilgrims at the hotel and finalizing check-in procedures.
4	Confirming actual check-in data for pilgrims on the Nusuk Masar platform.
5	Commitment to providing all housing-related services and features as per the contract with the pilgrims.
6	Retaining accommodation invoices issued by hotels, detailing the pilgrims' names and the specific period of stay.

B. Transportation Services:

No.	Regulations
1	Contracting with transport companies licensed by the Transport General Authority and qualified by the General Syndicate of Cars.
2	Providing all transportation-related services and features as per the contract with the pilgrims.
3	Creating the "Boarding Order" via the Nusuk Masar platform, including details of the vehicle, pilgrims, departure destination, and trips from ports (Air, Land, or Sea) at least 12 hours prior to the departure time.
4	Placing identification stickers on luggage with the names and details of the pilgrims.
5	Prior coordination with the transport company regarding trip timings and assembly points.
6	Accurately informing pilgrims of the boarding time and assembly location, ensuring their compliance with instructions.
7	Verifying flight availability via the Nusuk Masar platform according to the flight schedule (ensuring no cancellations or schedule changes) during departure preparation stages: (before summoning buses to the accommodation, before pilgrims descend for boarding, and before the buses move).

C. "Guest Without Bag" Services:

No.	Regulations
1	Contracting with qualified service providers via the Nusuk Masar platform.
2	The Umrah company is committed to receiving all bags from the service provider at the accommodation, verifying their (condition, count, etc.), and delivering them to the pilgrims.
3	The Umrah company is committed to reporting lost luggage and following up on procedures with the service provider.

D. Catering Services:

No.	Regulations
1	Contracting with licensed catering service providers via the Nusuk Masar platform.
2	The Umrah company is committed to accurately specifying (menus, number of pilgrims, and the agreement period).
٣	The Umrah company is committed to providing catering services as per the contract with the pilgrims.

E. Charter Flight Services:

No.	Regulations
1	Contracting with licensed service providers via the Nusuk Masar platform.
2	The Umrah company is committed to accurately specifying the (number of pilgrims and the agreement period).
٣	The Umrah company is committed to providing charter flight services as per the contract with the pilgrims.

Eighth: Regulations for the "Virtual Agent" Model:

The Virtual Agent is a licensed Saudi Umrah company or establishment that provides its services directly in the pilgrim's country without the need for an external intermediary, subject to regulatory requirements that ensure a legal presence in those countries. The supporting documents and justifications include:

- A. Commercial Registration in the pilgrim's country.
- B. Practice License in the same country.
- C. Bank account details for the Virtual Agent.
- D. Identification documents for the Principal Authorized Representative, including (Passport and Authorization Letter).

Ninth: Comprehensive Insurance Service Regulations:

Comprehensive Insurance is a primary requirement for visa issuance requests. The policy is considered valid for (90) days from the date of entry into the Kingdom and includes the following benefits:

1. Providing emergency health services to the pilgrim in all government hospitals/health centers affiliated with the Ministry of Health, and private hospitals and health centers approved by the Council of Health Insurance (CHI), according to the insurance policy benefits.

2. Insurance against accidents and disasters that the pilgrim may face, God forbid.
3. Coverage for flight delays or cancellations according to the approved policy benefits.
4. Repatriation of the pilgrim's remains to their home country, whether the death is natural or due to an accident.
5. Insurance compensations according to the insurance policy benefits.

Note: The comprehensive insurance policy does not conflict with or replace the regulations and systems followed by relevant authorities and carriers. (A copy of the insurance policy is attached).

Tenth: Regulations for Absconding Reports and Visa Extension Requests:

A. Absconding Reports (Overstaying):

1. Submitting an absconding report via the "Muqem" platform 24 hours before the expiration of the residency validity in the visa.
2. Verification by the Ministry—before processing the request—of the Umrah company's commitment to providing the contracted services to the pilgrims according to the program, through digital indicators and field monitoring.

B. Visa Extension Requests:

1. Submitting a visa extension request via the "Muqem" platform, attaching the necessary justifications according to each case.
2. Umrah visa extension requests are processed exclusively for health and security cases based on regulatory justifications.

Eleventh: Regulations for Reception, Departure, and Inter-city Transportation:

1. Confirming program data, arrival, and departure flights via the "Nusuk Masar" platform (72) hours prior to the pilgrims' arrival.
2. Creating the "Boarding Order" via the "Nusuk Masar" platform for transporting pilgrims to and from air, sea, and land ports, and between cities, according to the pilgrim's contracted program.
3. Printing the "Boarding Order," verifying the accuracy of the data (vehicle route and destination, list of pilgrims and visitors on board, vehicle and driver data), and delivering a copy to the vehicle driver.
4. Re-verifying the accuracy of flight data and take-off times before pilgrims depart from their accommodation.
5. Transporting departing pilgrims via air and sea ports so that their arrival time at the departure halls is at least (4) hours and at most (6) hours before the flight take-off or ferry departure. Umrah companies and establishments must calculate the time required for this from the moment buses move from the accommodation in Makkah or Madinah, taking into account peak days/hours and the routes used. The regulatory committees of the Ministry of Hajj and Umrah may estimate the appropriate timeframe according to the operational reality of each port during different seasons throughout the year.

6. Emphasizing to pilgrims the necessity of adhering to the specifications and sizes of luggage as approved by the competent authorities.
7. Emphasizing to pilgrims not to place "Zamzam" water bottles inside suitcases; adherence is required for one bottle per pilgrim, which must be specifically designated for air freight.
8. The Umrah company or establishment shall bear the responsibility for violating the regulations and all resulting consequences, whether securing shelter, meals, or transportation until the actual time of the alternative flight.
9. Monitoring pilgrims who missed their pre-booked flights and ensuring they are not transported to the airports until confirmed alternative bookings are secured.
10. Directing departing buses to air ports to pass through "Grouping Centers" (Tafweej) to complete departure procedures.
11. Monitoring updates to air carrier requirements based on the pilgrim's home country conditions upon departure to anticipate any travel denials, and the licensee shall bear the responsibility for hosting them.
12. In the event of the Umrah company's failure to transport the pilgrim according to the agreed program, alternative transportation will be provided by the General Syndicate of Cars in accordance with the attached Alternative Transport Policy document.
13. Periodic follow-up of alerts and circulars related to weather and rain conditions, and executing boarding operations in a manner that ensures the safety of pilgrims.
14. Prohibiting the transportation of pilgrims directly from Makkah to Prince Mohammed bin Abdulaziz Airport in Madinah unless there is an accommodation program in Madinah for at least (24) hours before heading to the airport.
15. Prohibiting the transportation of pilgrims directly from Prince Mohammed bin Abdulaziz Airport in Madinah to Makkah unless there is an accommodation program in Madinah for at least (24) hours before heading to Makkah.
16. Reception of pilgrims by Umrah company representatives at air ports is prohibited; reception and farewell services shall be provided solely by the company assigned by the Ministry for this task.

Twelfth: Regulations for Violations Referred to the Pilgrims' Complaint Committee in Case of Service Breach by Umrah Companies and Establishments:

A. Article 7 of the Regulations for Services to Umrah Pilgrims and Visitors of the Prophet's Mosque Arriving from Outside the Kingdom stipulates that, without prejudice to any severer penalty provided by law, the licensed establishment or company that breaches any provision of the aforementioned regulations and its executive rules shall be punished with one or more of the following penalties:

1. A financial fine not exceeding fifty thousand Saudi Riyals (SAR 50,000).
2. Suspension of the license for a period not exceeding six months during the Umrah visa season.
3. Cancellation of the license granted to the establishment or company.

B. Without prejudice to the right to claim civil damages, an external licensed entity shall be barred from dealing with licensed establishments and companies within the Kingdom if it breaches its contractual obligations.

C. Anyone providing services to pilgrims without obtaining the necessary license shall be punished with a fine not exceeding one hundred thousand Saudi Riyals (SAR 100,000).

D. Service Violations Reviewed by the Pilgrims' Complaint Committee:

No.	Violation	Description of Violation
1	Failure to provide accommodation	The licensee's failure to secure accommodation for pilgrims in Makkah and Madinah.
2	Delay in providing accommodation for more than two hours	The company or establishment's failure to house pilgrims in the agreed-upon accommodation for more than two hours.
3	Providing accommodation at a lower level than contracted	The company or establishment housing pilgrims in accommodation below the standard registered in the Ministry's system.
4	Accommodation not licensed by the Ministry of Tourism	The licensee housing pilgrims in accommodation that is not licensed by the Ministry of Tourism.
5	Failure to provide transport upon departure from accommodation	The licensee's failure to secure buses during the pilgrims' departure from their residences in Makkah and Madinah.
6	Providing transport at a lower level than contracted	The licensee securing means of transport using buses at a lower standard than what was agreed upon.
7	Delay in transport service	The licensee's failure or delay in securing means of transport for pilgrims.
8	Transport via unlicensed means	The licensee providing buses that are not approved by the General Syndicate of Cars.
9	Failure to follow up on cases of patients, hospitalized, deceased, or detained pilgrims	The licensee's failure to follow up on pilgrims who are hospitalized, deceased, or finalizing their procedures, or failure to follow up on pilgrims detained in prisons.
10	Non-compliance with arrival times at the port	The licensee's failure to transport pilgrims to the departure port within the specified timeframe (4 to 6 hours) as per the circulars issued by the Ministry.
11	Failure of pilgrims to depart from the port (Missed Flight)	The licensee sending pilgrims to the port of arrival after their flight has already departed.
12	Failure to provide transport upon arrival at the port (Grouping/Tafweej)	The licensee's failure to organize the grouping (Tafweej) of pilgrims sufficiently in advance of their scheduled arrival time.

Thirteenth: Mechanism for Reviewing Violations by the Pilgrims' Complaint Committee:

1. Interested parties shall be notified of the date for reviewing the complaint or violation at least seven days prior to the scheduled date. The notification must include a statement of the substance of the complaint or violation and require the defendant to appear in person or through a legal

representative to provide testimony and submit any relevant documents. The committee must review the complaint or violation expeditiously.

2. The subject of the complaint should be resolved within a period not exceeding thirty days from the date of its submission.
3. Subject to the provisions of Article (45) of these regulations, the pilgrim is not required to remain in the Kingdom after the expiration of their residency period for the proceedings to continue. However, the pilgrim may attend sessions during their stay or appoint a legal representative if they so wish.
4. Interested parties shall be notified of the date for reviewing the complaint or violation via a hand-delivered letter, telegram, registered mail, or email. The absence of the claimant shall not prevent the proceedings from continuing.
5. The defendant shall be notified of the Minister of Hajj and Umrah's decision regarding the penalty via registered mail sent to the address registered with the Ministry or the address chosen during the review of the complaint or violation.
6. After reviewing the recommendations submitted by the committee, the Minister of Hajj and Umrah may issue a decision imposing one or more penalties deemed appropriate from those stipulated in Article 7 of the Regulations.
7. The interested party has the right to appeal the penalty decision before the Board of Grievances within sixty days from the date of notification. The decision of the Board of Grievances shall be final.

Fourteenth: Operational Violations:

These are violations by companies of the rules and instructions outlined in this document or any instructions issued by the Ministry or competent authorities. These are not reviewed by the Complaint Committee as they are considered operational rather than service-related. However, they are calculated within the performance indicators and periodic evaluation of companies and directly affect classification and promotion processes. The Ministry reserves the right to take necessary measures against companies committing such violations, including suspending their account on the Nusuk Masar platform, alongside necessary regulatory actions based on the severity and frequency of the violation.

Fifteenth: Policy for Handling the Following Violations:

No.	Violation	Violation Description	Handling Policy
1	Low Data Quality Violation	If the company's total entries and departures	Upon detection of the violation:

No.	Violation	Violation Description	Handling Policy
		exceed 200 pilgrims during the period, and the data quality indicator is below 60%.	- First time within a month: A warning is issued to the company. - Second time within a month: System suspension for 24 hours. - Third time within a month: System suspension for 72 hours. <i>If the low data quality violation is recorded against the company more than (5) times during the season, issuance for nationalities with a rate below (60%) will be suspended until the end of the season.</i>
2	Overstaying Violation (Delay in Departure)	The pilgrim's failure to depart within the visa validity period.	If overstaying cases are detected for any nationality—whether in the 1447 or 1448 seasons—totaling (10) pilgrims or more, or 1% of the total number for that nationality (whichever is reached first), the company's account for that nationality will be suspended. The company will be barred from requesting any new visas until the overstaying pilgrims depart or their number falls below (10).
3	Exceeding Program Duration Violation	The company's failure to adhere to the duration specified in the pilgrim's program agreed upon via the Nusuk platform.	If the pilgrims' commitment rate to the specified program duration falls below (90%) for a single contract, the Umrah company's contract with the external agent will be suspended until the situation is rectified.
4	Serious Violations	Violations that affect the pilgrim's safety, cause direct harm, or expose them to health and security risks, including: housing not licensed by competent authorities, failure to secure accommodation as agreed, or failure to provide flight tickets before the pilgrim reaches the departure airport.	The approved penalties for serious violations are applied as follows: -If the case is rectified within no more than two hours from the notification time, the company is suspended for (7) days. If the violation is repeated during the suspension period, it is extended to (10) days. -If the rectification period exceeds two hours without correcting the situation, the previous penalty is applied, plus a (5%) reduction in the Umrah company's approved performance evaluation, and the case is recorded within the operational evaluation indicators.

Sixteenth: Periodic Performance Evaluation Criteria for Umrah Companies and Establishments:

Within the framework of its responsibility to supervise Umrah companies, establishments, external agents, and the contracts between them regarding the services provided to pilgrims, the Ministry is keen to

periodically measure the performance and efficiency of companies on a monthly basis. This is conducted through a set of indicators and criteria according to the methodology detailed in the appendix attached to this document.

Seventeenth: Regulations for Services Provided to Individual Pilgrims via Direct Umrah Platforms and Approved Online Travel Agencies (OTAs):

Procedures and service programs for individual pilgrims are organized according to an operational framework aimed at elevating the quality of services provided to the Guests of Allah, enhancing transparency in the presentation of packages and services, and enabling beneficiaries to design or select Umrah programs that suit their needs via approved digital channels. Additionally, this framework regulates service providers' obligations and associated performance standards to ensure an integrated experience and improved efficiency. To achieve this, services for pilgrims arriving through this channel will be available to Umrah companies within the Green and Yellow categories.

And Allah is the Arbiter of Success,,,

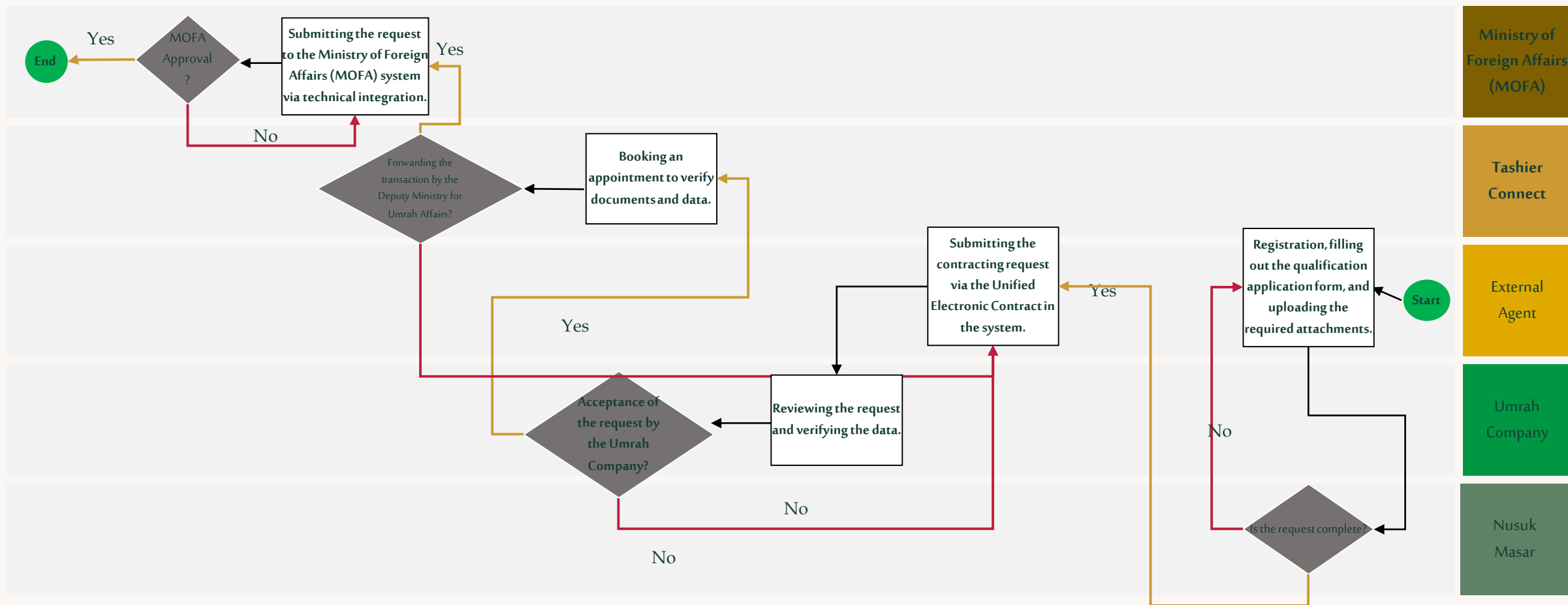


The Preparatory Meeting for the 1448 AH Umrah Season

Deputy Ministry for Umrah Affairs - May 2026



Workflow Model for External Agent Qualification and Contracting Requests



At the beginning of the 1448 AH season: All qualification requests will be processed/passed for agents who operated during the 1447 AH season without going through the "Tashier Connect" step, provided that data and documents are updated by booking an appointment at Tashier Connect offices within 45 days.

Welcome Speech by His Excellency the Deputy Minister for Umrah Affairs

Umrah in Numbers: 1447 AH

Key Directions for the Year 1448 AH

Launch of the 1448 Season Badge Initiative

Workflow Model for Qualification and Contracting Requests

Classification Methodology for International Agencies

Classification Methodology for Umrah Companies

Contractual Relationship Based on Classification Results

Launch of the Pilgrim Souvenirs Initiative

Content

Agents' Performance Indicators

Measurement Method	Sub-Weight	Sub-Performance Indicators	Weight	Criteria
Percentage of data matching between the data registered by the company and the approved data from government entities (National Information Center, Passenger Security Center)	15%	Percentage of overstaying departures beyond the visa duration	45%	Program Adherence
	15%	- Land or sea trip: Entry port / Entry date - Air trip: Arrival flight data		
	15%	- Land or sea trip: Exit port / Exit date - Air trip: Departure flight data		
Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the premium category out of the total number of pilgrims	7%	Premium Packages	15%	Service Packages Diversity
Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the medium category out of the total number of pilgrims	5%	Medium Packages		
Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the economic category out of the total number of pilgrims	3%	Economic Packages		
Percentage of the Umrah company's satisfaction with the external agent	5%	Umrah companies' satisfaction with external agents	15%	Pilgrim Experience & Service Quality
Percentage of pilgrims who benefited from enrichment sites approved by regional authorities and the Guests of Allah Service Program out of the total number of pilgrims	10%	Qualitative enrichment services		
Percentage of the number of groups out of the total number of groups	10%	Group Leader	25%	Pilgrim Awareness
Percentage of distributed cards out of the total number of pilgrims	10%	Nusuk Card		
Percentage of registered data out of the total pilgrim data	5%	Pilgrim contact data		

Agents are divided into tiers where tiers are distributed based on the number and flow of pilgrims in each month, taking into account seasonal considerations in pilgrim numbers*

Ramadan	Sha'ban	Rajab	Jumada al-Akhirah	Jumada al-Ula	Rabi ath-Thani	Rabi al-Awwal	Safar	Muharram	
950+ pilgrims monthly			600+ pilgrims monthly			300+ pilgrims monthly			First Tier
351-950 pilgrims monthly			201-600 pilgrims monthly			101-300 pilgrims monthly			Second Tier
10-350 pilgrims monthly			10-200 pilgrims monthly			10-100 pilgrims monthly			Third Tier

In case the number of pilgrims does not exceed 10 pilgrims in the month, the company is considered unclassified

Red	Orange	Yellow	Green	 Company Category
Less than 60%	From 60% to 69.99%	From 70% to 81.99%	More than 82%	First Tier
Less than 65%	From 65% to 74.99%	From 75% to 86.99%	More than 87%	Second Tier
Less than 70%	From 70% to 79.99%	From 80% to 91.99%	More than 92%	Third Tier

Score for Criteria

Agents are evaluated on a monthly basis based on the specified performance indicator scores, and the company's category is promoted or demoted monthly accordingly

After completing the evaluation of agents according to the performance indicator results and classifying them within the approved tiers, specific incentives or deductions are applied that affect the company's final score.

Negative Calculation

Serious Violations

A deduction of -5% is made from the evaluation if any of the following violations are detected: (unlicensed accommodation, failure to provide flight tickets before departure, failure to secure accommodation) and similar serious violations.

Positive Calculation

Distribution of Souvenirs

The increase is granted based on the approved methodology.

Umrah +

An increase of +10% is granted in the evaluation if more than 50% of the pilgrims benefit from it during the month. These are enrichment programs outside Makkah and Madinah, including accommodation booking through online travel agencies (OTAs) integrated with Nusuk Masar.

Ministry Awards

An increase of +5% is granted in the evaluation if the company receives any award announced by the Ministry.

After completing the application of incentives or deductions, the following penalties apply to agencies within the Red Category.

Penalties on the Red Category

- At the beginning of the 1448 AH season: If the weighted average for the annual performance of the agent (for the 1447 AH Umrah season) falls within the Red Category, the agent will be suspended for one month from the start of the season.
- After the 1448 AH season: If the weighted average for the annual performance of the agent falls within the Red Category, the agent will be suspended and not allowed to operate in the new season.

- During operations within the season, accountability is conducted on a monthly basis, where the agent is suspended for the first time for two weeks, for the second time for a month, and for the third time until the end of the season.

Annual Evaluation



Monthly Evaluation

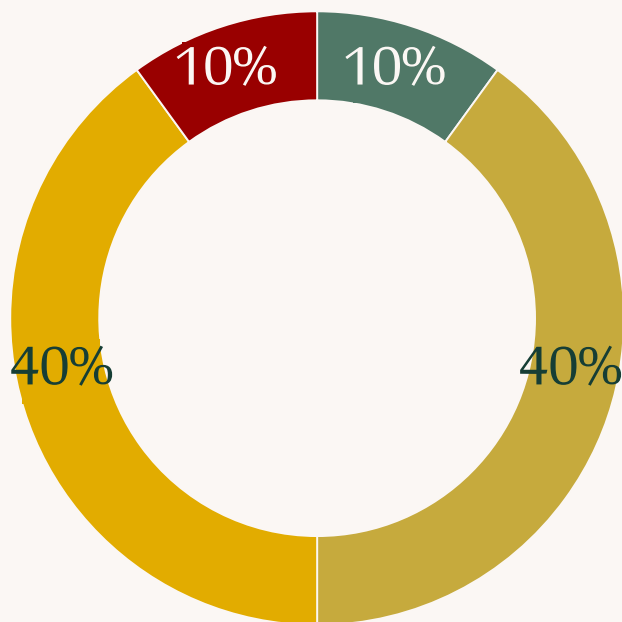


The regulatory matrix for business models in the Umrah sector (Green and Yellow categories) will be able to operate within the Direct Umrah model and OTAs.

Regulatory Matrix for the Umrah Sector				Company Categories Business Models in the Umrah Sector
 Contract Not Allowed	 Contract Allowed			
Red	Orange	Yellow	Green	
				Direct Umrah Model
				Online Travel Agencies (OTAs) Model

Standard deviation will be applied to the categories based on the performance of all companies to raise performance standards in the sector

Green Orange The Final Target for Agency Classification in Each Country After
Yellow Red Applying Standard Deviation



Percentages may change based on seasonality or the number of companies in the tier based on the results for that month

•The standard deviation is applied to continuously elevate the performance of the sector, and this aligns with best international practices in performance evaluation and improvement.

•To clarify, in the event that 10% of the companies do not achieve the score that qualifies them to reach the Green Category, the highest-rated companies in the Yellow Category will be elevated to the Green Category to fulfill the required percentage of total companies, and the reverse is also true.

The standard deviation will not be applied if the number of agencies in the country is less than 30 agents

Welcome Speech by His Excellency the Deputy Minister for Umrah Affairs

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Companies' Performance Indicators

Measurement Method	Sub-Weight	Sub-Performance Indicators	Weight	Criteria
• Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the premium category out of the total number of pilgrims	7%	Premium Packages	15%	Service Packages Diversity
• Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the medium category out of the total number of pilgrims	5%	Medium Packages		
• Percentage of pilgrims who purchased packages within the approved price range for the economic category out of the total number of pilgrims	3%	Economic Packages		
• Average results of the pilgrim satisfaction questionnaire	10%	% Pilgrim Satisfaction	45%	Pilgrim Experience & Service Quality
• Average evaluation of the Umrah company's service performance quality	5%	% Service Performance Quality		
• Percentage of reports that companies committed to closing and handling in accordance with the Service Level Agreement (SLA)	10%	% Commitment to Handling Reports		
• Percentage of pilgrims who benefited from enrichment sites approved by regional authorities and the Guests of Allah Service Program out of the total number of pilgrims	10%	% Qualitative Enrichment Services		
• Percentage of pilgrims unaffected by violations out of the total number of pilgrims during inspection visits	10%	% Companies' Commitment to Services and Regulations		
• Percentage of data matching between the data registered by the company and the approved data from government entities (National Information Center, Passenger Security Center)	10%	• Land or sea trip: Entry port / Entry date • Air trip: Arrival flight data	40%	Program Adherence
• Average results of the pilgrim satisfaction questionnaire	5%	Arrival Boarding Order		
• Average evaluation of the Umrah company's service performance quality	5%	Intercity Boarding Order		
• Percentage of reports that companies committed to closing and handling in accordance with the Service Level Agreement (SLA)	5%	Departure Boarding Order		
• Percentage of pilgrims who benefited from enrichment sites approved by regional authorities and the Guests of Allah Service Program out of the total number of pilgrims	10%	• Land or sea trip: Exit port / Exit date • Air trip: Departure flight data		
• Percentage of pilgrims unaffected by violations out of the total number of pilgrims during inspection visits	5%	Housing Confirmation		

Companies are divided into tiers where tiers are distributed based on the number and flow of pilgrims in each month, taking into account seasonal considerations in pilgrim numbers*

Ramadan	Sha'ban	Rajab	Jumada al-Akhirah	Jumada al-Ula	Rabi ath-Thani	Rabi al-Awwal	Safar	Muharram	
8,000+ pilgrims monthly			6,000+ pilgrims monthly			4,000+ pilgrims monthly			First Tier
1,600-7,999 pilgrims monthly			1,100-5,999 pilgrims monthly			600-3,999 pilgrims monthly			Second Tier
200-1,599 pilgrims monthly			200-1,099 pilgrims monthly			200-599 pilgrims monthly			Third Tier

In case the number of pilgrims does not exceed 200 pilgrims in the month, the company is considered unclassified

أحمر	Orange	Yellow	Green	 Company Category
Less than 60%	From 60% to 69.99%	From 70% to 81.99%	More than 82%	First Tier
Less than 65%	From 65% to 74.99%	From 75% to 86.99%	More than 87%	Second Tier
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Score for Criteria

Companies are evaluated on a monthly basis based on the specified performance indicator scores, and the company's category is promoted or demoted monthly accordingly

After completing the evaluation of companies according to the performance indicator results and classifying them within the approved tiers, specific incentives or deductions are applied that affect the company's final score.

Negative Calculation

Serious Violations

A deduction of -5% is made from the evaluation if any of the following violations are detected: (unlicensed accommodation, failure to provide flight tickets before departure, failure to secure accommodation) and similar serious violations.

Positive Calculation

Distribution of Souvenirs

The increase is granted based on the approved methodology.

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- During operations within the season, accountability is conducted on a monthly basis, where the company is suspended for the first time for two weeks, for the second time for a month, and for the third time until the end of the season.

Annual Evaluation

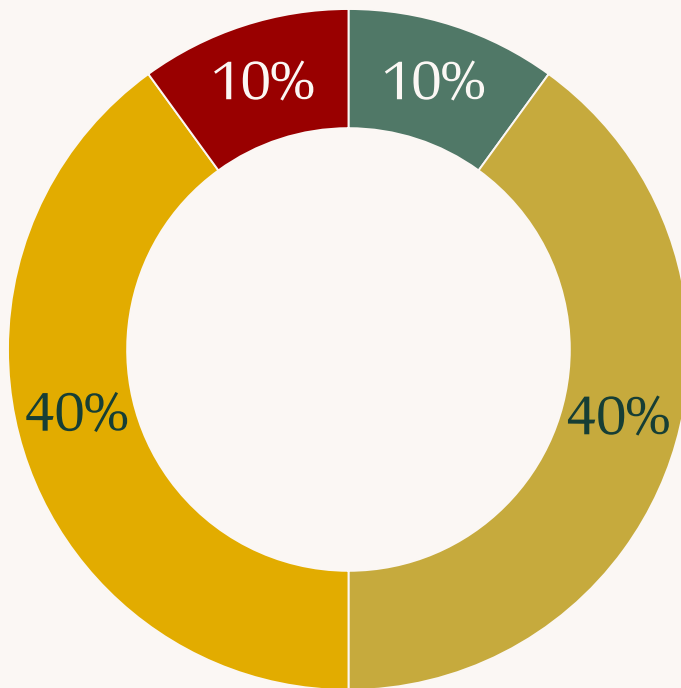


Monthly Evaluation



Standard deviation will be applied to the categories based on the performance of all companies to raise performance standards in the sector

Green Orange Yellow Red **The Final Target for Company Classification After Applying Standard Deviation**



Percentages may change based on seasonality or the number of companies in the tier based on the results for that month

- The standard deviation is applied to continuously elevate the performance of the sector, and this aligns with best international practices in performance evaluation and improvement.
- To clarify, in the event that 10% of the companies do not achieve the score that qualifies them to reach the Green Category, the highest-rated companies in the Yellow Category will be elevated to the Green Category to fulfill the required percentage of total companies, and the reverse is also true.

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The Ministry periodically reclassifies companies and agents, which may lead to the shifting of contractual relationships into an unpermitted status.

 Contract Not Allowed		 Contract Allowed		Regulatory Matrix for the Umrah Sector	
Red	Orange	Yellow	Green	Company Tiers Agent Tiers	
				Green	
				Yellow	
				Orange	
				Red	

The regulatory matrix for the Umrah sector has been updated to place caps on unpermitted contractual relationships, allowing for performance improvement during the season.

 Contract Not Allowed		 Contract Allowed		Regulatory Matrix for the Umrah Sector	
Red		Orange		Yellow	
Green		Company Tiers		Agent Tiers	
					
Maximum Cap					
Maximum Cap		Maximum Cap			
		Maximum Cap		Maximum Cap	
					

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1- Incentives Mechanism and Steps for Umrah Companies' Participation

The mechanism relies on motivating Umrah companies to present souvenirs to pilgrims, by granting an increase in the company's evaluation based on the number of presented gifts and their categories in the 1448 Umrah season.

The increase is calculated according to a pilgrim points system, taking into account the number of gifts presented and their categories, as follows:

- **Economic Category:** 1 point per gift
- **Medium Category:** 4 points per gift
- **Premium Category:** 20 points per gift

Note: The company is granted an increase in the evaluation not exceeding 5%, calculated according to the percentage of achieved points out of a maximum of 8,000 points as an upper limit for each Umrah company.

Steps to Participate in the Initiative

- Fill out contract data with gift companies via the following form:
[QR Code]



- Send timelines and locations of gift distribution to pilgrims to the account manager and to the following email:
UmrahBD@Haj.gov.sa
- Document distribution operations with the account manager

Samples of Gift Categories

Premium Category



Medium Category



Economic Category



Thank you